10 Videos to Watch Instead of Brain Rot

Free videos, playlists, and podcasts that cover what you need for investment banking recruiting: the job, the technicals, Excel, networking, and AI. Watch them in order if you're starting from zero.

1. What Bankers Actually Do

Hear it straight from a former investment bank CEO.

WHAT IT IS

Bloomberg's Odd Lots sits down with Scott Bok, longtime former CEO of the investment bank Greenhill, to break down what bankers do all day, why clients pay for it, what kind of people thrive, and how AI could change the job.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Use it to sharpen your answer to "what does an investment banker do?"
2. Note the language he uses about clients and deals, and borrow it in interviews.

SOURCE

Bloomberg / Odd Lots (video)

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.bloomberg.com/news/videos/2026-04-03/what-investment-bankers-actually-do-all-day-video

2. Finance Fundamentals

A full NYU finance class, free on YouTube.

WHAT IT IS

NYU Stern professor Aswath Damodaran posts his Foundations of Finance class as a free playlist. It covers time value of money, risk and return, and the core ideas every banking interview builds on.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Start here if you don't have a finance background.
2. Watch at 1.5x and take notes on anything you couldn't explain to a friend.

SOURCE

Aswath Damodaran, NYU Stern (YouTube playlist)

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLUkh9m2BorqndWimijiJ-VCAXjJUrzJQU

3. Accounting

Learn the three statements cold.

WHAT IT IS

Damodaran's accounting class, also free on YouTube. It walks through the income statement, balance sheet, and cash flow statement, which is the foundation of almost every technical question you'll get.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Practice walking a $10 change in depreciation through all three statements out loud.
2. Pull up a real 10-K and match what you learn to actual line items.

SOURCE

Aswath Damodaran, NYU Stern (YouTube playlist)

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLUkh9m2BorqmKaLrNBjKtFDhpdFdi8f7C

4. Walk Me Through a DCF

The most common technical question in banking.

WHAT IT IS

A step-by-step breakdown of how to answer "walk me through a DCF": projecting free cash flow, calculating terminal value, discounting at WACC, and getting to enterprise and equity value.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Get your answer under two minutes without rambling.
2. Prepare for follow-ups like "what happens to the DCF if interest rates rise?"

SOURCE

YouTube

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hZALF58_qsY

5. Valuation

The NYU valuation course people pay to get into.

WHAT IT IS

Damodaran's full valuation class: intrinsic valuation, relative valuation with multiples, and how comps, precedents, and DCFs fit together.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Focus on the relative valuation sessions to understand comps.
2. Learn why precedent transactions usually come in higher than trading comps.

SOURCE

Aswath Damodaran, NYU Stern (YouTube playlist)

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLUkh9m2BorqkYrFjNdut81IIcYdLfgqNd

6. How an LBO Works

How private equity uses debt to buy companies.

WHAT IT IS

Khan Academy's plain-English intro to the leveraged buyout: how a buyer funds an acquisition with mostly borrowed money and why leverage magnifies returns.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Once it clicks, practice a simple paper LBO with round numbers.
2. Be ready to explain what makes a company a good LBO target.

SOURCE

Khan Academy (video)

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.khanacademy.org/economics-finance-domain/core-finance/stock-and-bonds/leveraged-buy-outs/v/basic-leveraged-buyout-lbo

7. Excel Shortcuts

Model faster without touching your mouse.

WHAT IT IS

A former J.P. Morgan investment banking analyst, with Wall Street Prep, shows the keyboard shortcuts and formatting habits used to build financial models quickly.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Unplug your mouse for a week and force yourself to use shortcuts.
2. Learn the blue-for-inputs, black-for-formulas color convention.

SOURCE

Wall Street Prep (YouTube)

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oDjhg57XH-A

8. Cold Emails

Get replies from bankers starting from zero connections.

WHAT IT IS

An Adventis Coffee Chat Podcast episode on writing cold emails that stand out, building real relationships, and using networking calls to practice your pitch.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Keep emails short, specific, and easy to say yes to.
2. Send updates over time instead of repeated asks.

SOURCE

Adventis Coffee Chat Podcast, Episode 21

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.adventiscg.com/podcast/mastering-cold-emails-networking-for-investment-banking

9. Real Stories from People Who Broke In

Proof that starting late or non-target isn't the end.

WHAT IT IS

Wall Street Oasis shares student stories, including one who sent 3,000 emails and did 85 networking calls before landing a Wells Fargo investment banking offer.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Pick one story and copy the system, not just the motivation.
2. Track your outreach in a spreadsheet so you can see your numbers.

SOURCE

Wall Street Oasis Podcast

WHERE TO WATCH

https://podcasts.apple.com/ca/podcast/wall-street-oasis/id1463441793

10. AI in Finance

See how banks and PE firms are actually using AI.

WHAT IT IS

A recorded Anthropic session with leaders from RBC Capital Markets, The Carlyle Group, and Moody's on using AI for deal execution, investment analysis, and Excel workflows.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Learn to use AI to research companies and prep for interviews.
2. Have a point of view ready if an interviewer asks how AI will change banking.

SOURCE

Anthropic (recorded webinar)

WHERE TO WATCH

https://www.anthropic.com/webinars/claude-for-financial-services

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